Form No. 723

Lesotho Meteorological Services
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Period 01st to 10th January 2026 | **Season: 2025/2026**

Issued on 14th January 2026 | **Bulletin No.6/6**

Ten-Day Agrometeorological Bulletin

…dedicated to the agricultural community

… aimed at harmonizing agricultural activities with weather and climate

Highlights

- **Rainfall deficit**

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Rainfall review (01-10 January 2026)

Rainfall

Fig. 1 shows low (blue) amounts of rainfall observed during the last ten days (dekad) of January 2026 compared to the long term (red) rainfall for the Dekad. Majority of the stations across the country registered less than average rains. The central parts (Semonkong-20.1mm) received highest amount followed by areas in the south (Mafeteng-18.2mm) and North (Botha-Bothe-17.7mm). The worst performers were Qacha's Nek and Oxbow with 1.4mm and 7.2mm respectively. Rainfall accumulation since the start of the season that is from August the 1st of 2025 (Fig.2) to date, illustrates the total rainfall to be above normal over many parts of the country. However the northern (Botha-Bothe) and south-eastern (Qacha's Nek) recorded less.

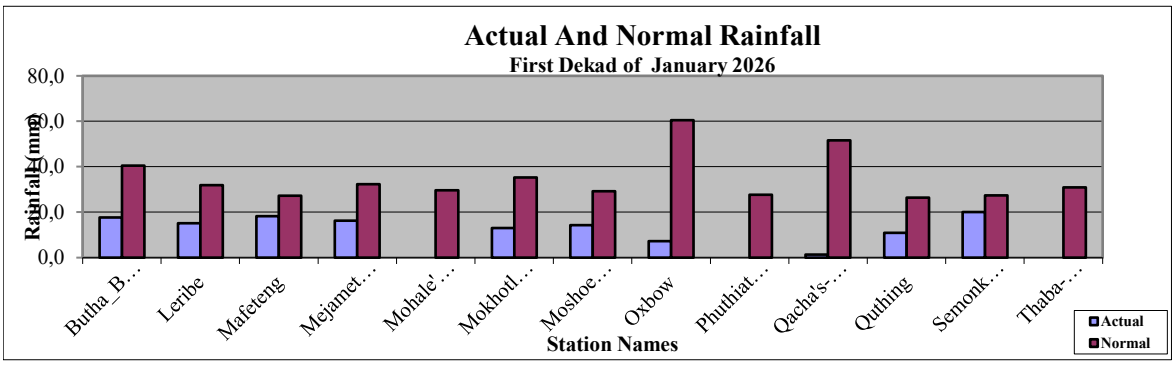

Fig. 1

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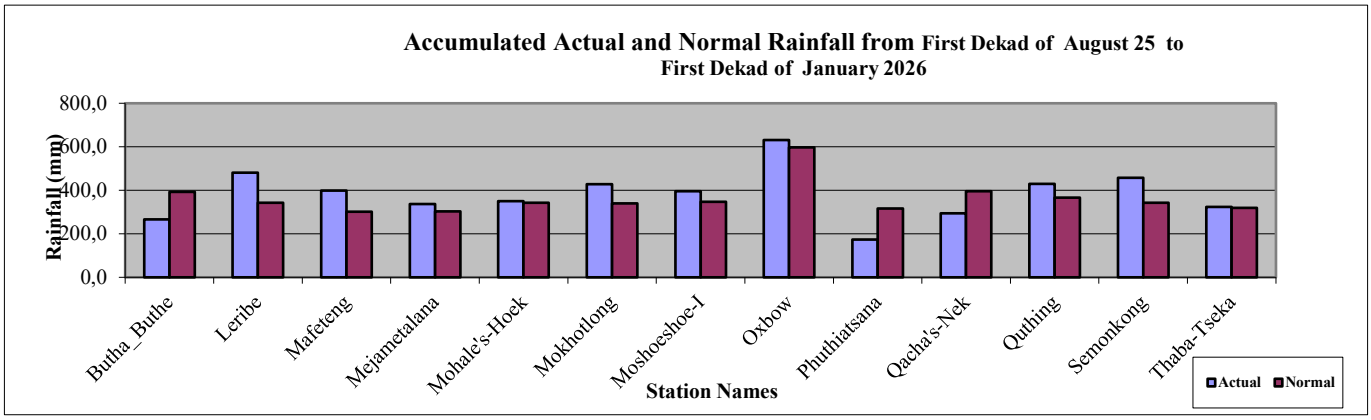

Fig.2 indicating dekadal rainfall accumulation from start of planting season (Aug in the highlands) to Dekad 1 of January 2026 as opposed to long term dekadal normals

Vegetation Health Index

Fig. 3 below illustrates the state of the health of vegetation for Dekad 1 January 2026. It shows the current state of vegetation health by showing the difference in greenness compared to Long Term Average (LTA) as shown by the vegetation index. Moving from red color (low values) is due to presence of Maluti Mountain and Drakensburg ranges, whereas deep green (high values) indicate healthy vegetation transtion from mountains into foothills and lowlands where vegetation increases.

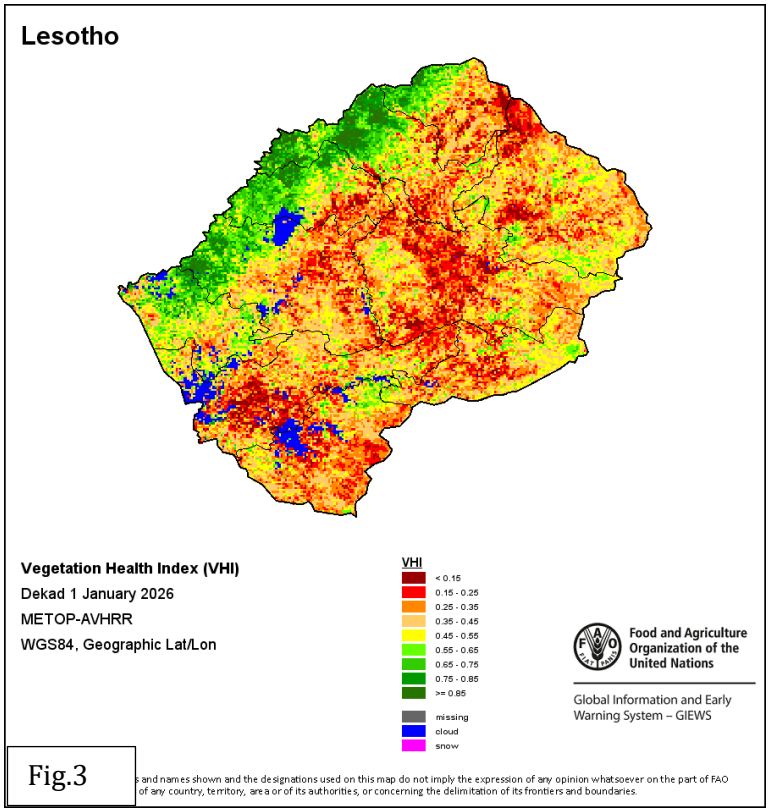

Fig.3

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Weather outlook (10th to 20th January 2026).

10th to 14th there is likelihood of Isolated to scattered rain and thunderstorms often accompanied by strong winds and intense heat.

Rest of the period 15th to 20th January 2026.

There is a likelihood of improved chances of scattered and moderate rains and thunderstorms often accompanied by strong winds and hailstorms. It is expected to remain hot over much of the period.

Seasonal Outlook (Feb-Mar-Apr 2026)

Normal to Above normal rain is anticipated. Temperature will be normal to slightly above normal.

N.B. It is important to note that during the summer season, flash floods, thunderstorms, hailstorms, heat waves, and strong winds are frequent and may result in the loss of lives while also posing possible damage to property and crops.

General Comments (Advisory)

Climate Smart Agriculture :

Farmers are advised to plant early maturing varieties, use protected structures especially for horticultural crops as temperatures are expected to be warmer. Irrigation schedules for horticultural crops are recommended to support crop growth and development.

Livestock farmers are advised to keep animals under protected structures for protection against intense heat and other weather extremes.

Heavy rainfall

Heavy rainfall can cause waterlogging in seedbeds, nutrient leaching in prepared fields, and rapid surface runoff leading to soil erosion. Farmers should ensure that drainage systems are clear to prevent field waterlogging.

General Recommendations:

- Regular consultations with Extension officers is highly recommended
- Daily weather monitoring and use of indigenous weather forecasts is recommended for signs of significant rainfall patterns shifts
- Water storage during heavy rainfall can be beneficial for irrigation and drinking for animals.

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